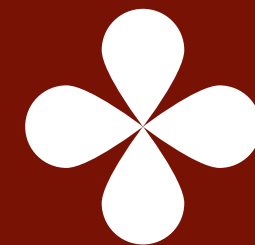


Yabesra Ewnetu and Catalina Giraldo



RAISING WOMEN IN POWER



at Duke and Beyond

Spring 2026

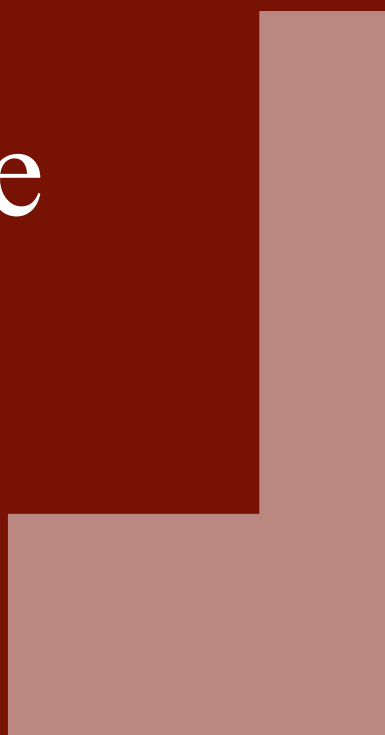


CLASS CHECK-IN

Reflections

- Each reflection should be 250 to 500 words, respond to the prompt, and demonstrate critical engagement with the text, next due: **2/1/26**

Local Connections

- Bring a news article that connects that week's topic to Duke University and share that article with the class. Sign-ups were open last week. Place your name on the sheet once as soon as possible
- 



POWER

Let's do an activity, what does power mean to you? A handout will be given to you and we'll discuss after 10 mins



LET'S DISCUSS

Statement	Your Opinion			
Power is physical force.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is wealth—having the resources that allow you to get things done.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is authority—having a position that allows you to tell people what to do.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is influence—being able to change a person's behavior.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is being able to control how other people treat you.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is using your position to treat people with consideration and respect.	SA	A	D	SD
Power is the ability to accomplish your goals.	SA	A	D	SD



1 = Strongly

Agree

2 = Agree

3 = Disagree

4 = Strongly

Disagree



*I FEEL LIKE I
HAVE POWER
WHEN.....*





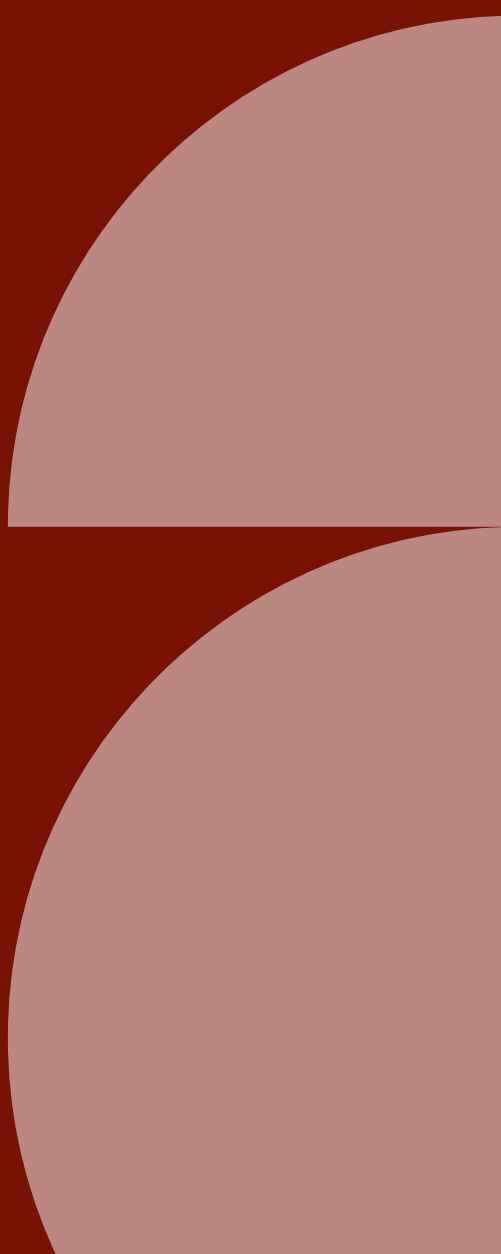
WHAT ARE DIFFERENT FRAMEWORKS FOR POWER

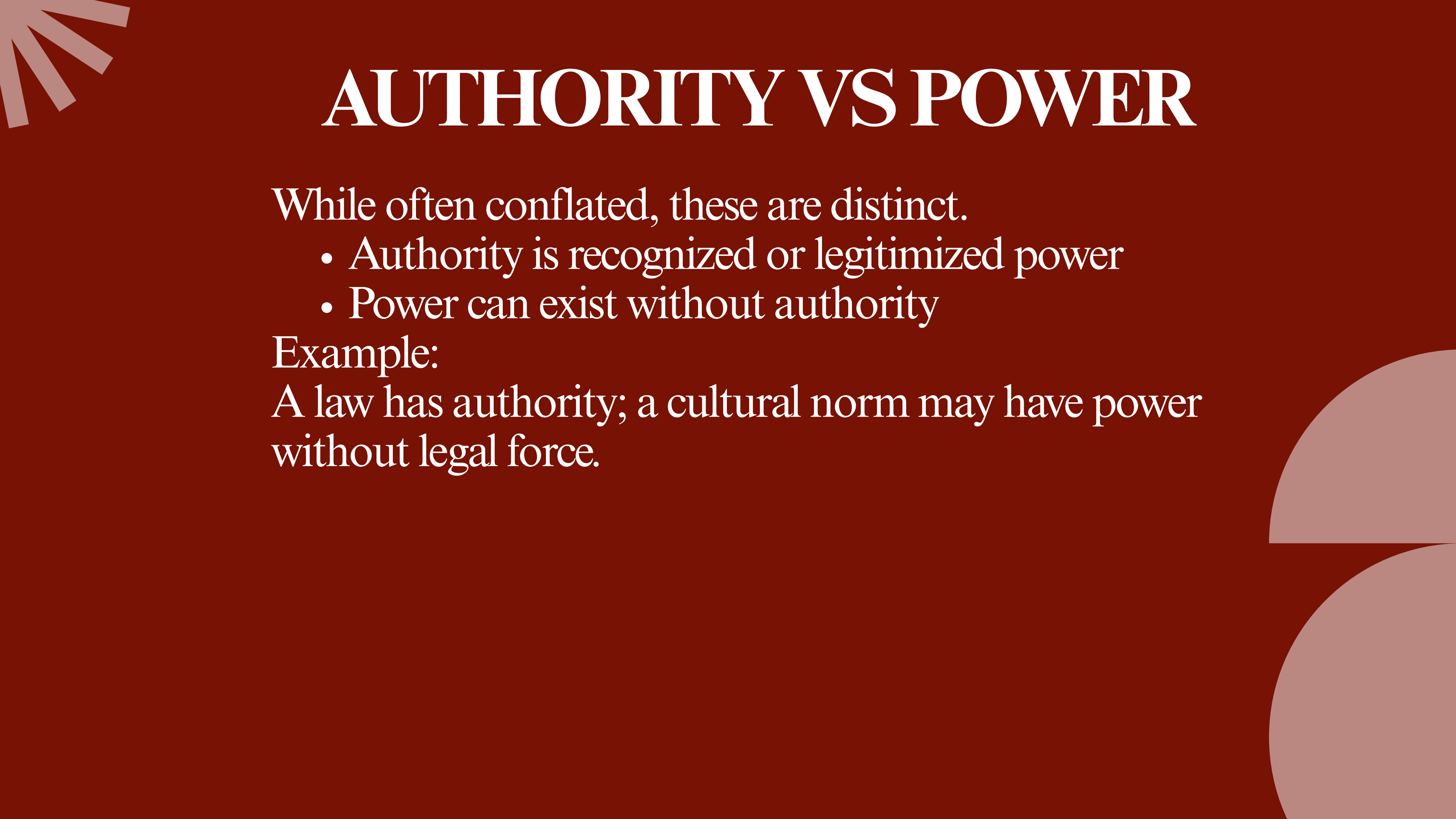
In sociology, power is understood as:

- Relational: it exists between people and groups
 - Power that operates in everyday interactions: relationships, classrooms, families, workplaces
- Contextual: it operates differently across settings
- Often invisible: it works best when it appears natural or inevitable

Power is not only about domination, but about whose reality becomes legitimate.

What are examples of this in our readings?



The slide features a dark red background. In the top-left corner, there is a decorative element consisting of several light red, rectangular bars of varying lengths radiating from a point. In the bottom-right corner, there are two overlapping light red circular shapes.

AUTHORITY VS POWER

While often conflated, these are distinct.

- Authority is recognized or legitimized power
- Power can exist without authority

Example:

A law has authority; a cultural norm may have power without legal force.



CULTURAL POWER

Power is embedded in shared meanings, beliefs, and norms.

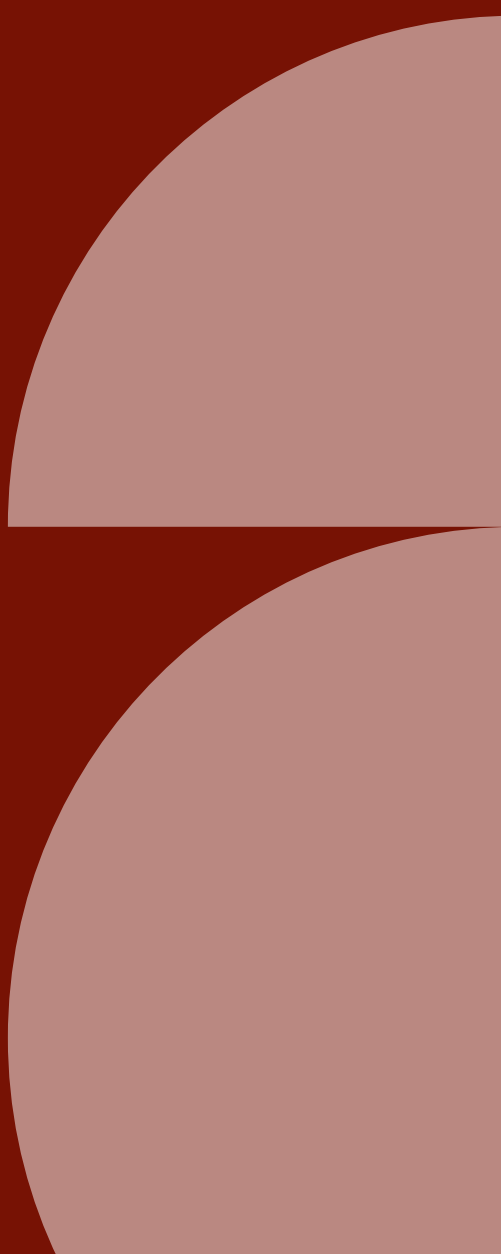
Includes:

- gender roles
- religious values
- moral frameworks
- ideas of “normal” or “natural.”

Cultural power:

- shapes identity
- defines legitimacy
- determines whose experiences are credible

Cultural power informs us on how to be before institutions dictate what to do.





INSITUATIONAL POWER

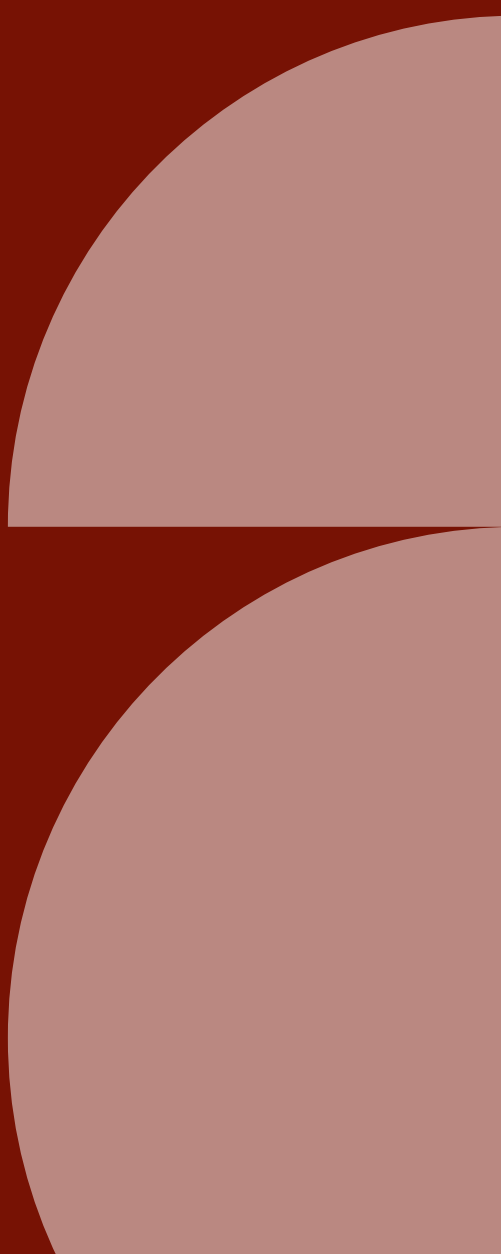
Power formalized through systems and organizations:

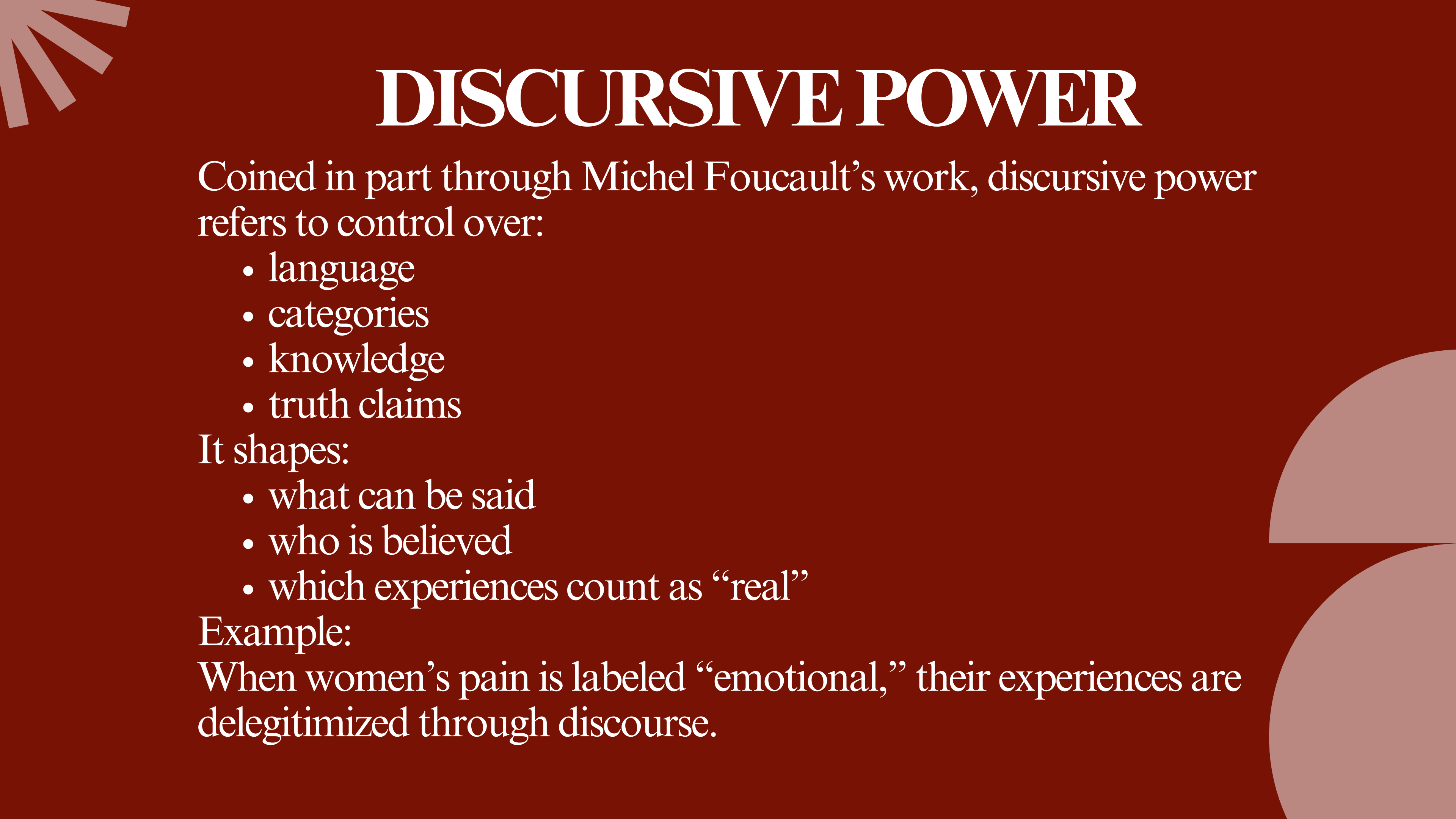
- law
- medicine
- education
- religion
- government

Characteristics:

- backed by policy or expertise
- appears objective or neutral
- Often resists accountability

Institutional power stabilizes cultural norms and enforces them at scale.





DISCURSIVE POWER

Coined in part through Michel Foucault's work, discursive power refers to control over:

- language
- categories
- knowledge
- truth claims

It shapes:

- what can be said
- who is believed
- which experiences count as “real”

Example:

When women's pain is labeled “emotional,” their experiences are delegitimized through discourse.

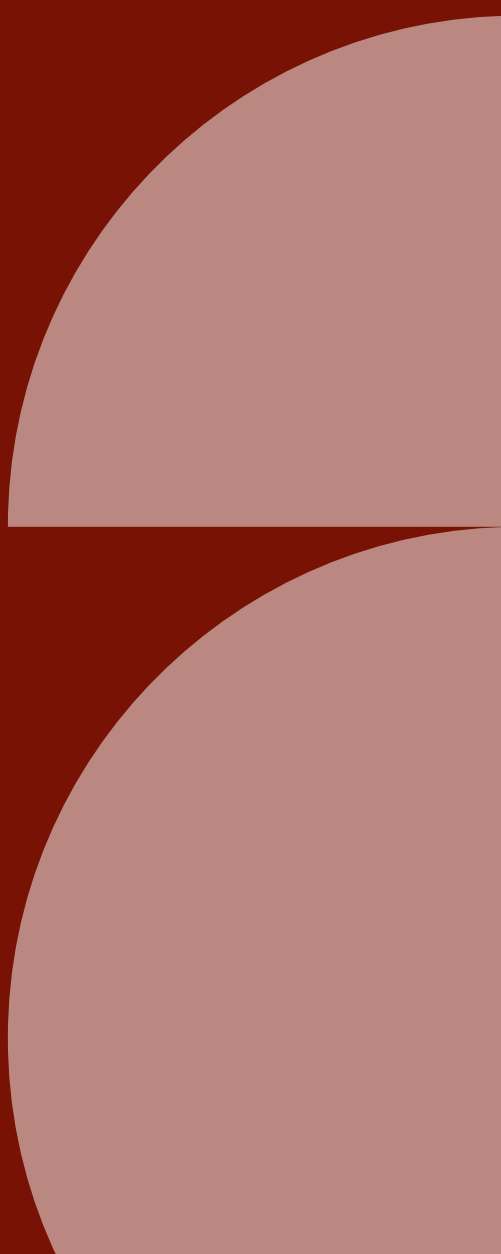


READING ANALYSIS

Power shapes womanhood by:

- defining acceptable behavior
- regulating bodies and safety
- determining credibility and visibility
- enforcing silence or compliance

This regulation occurs across:

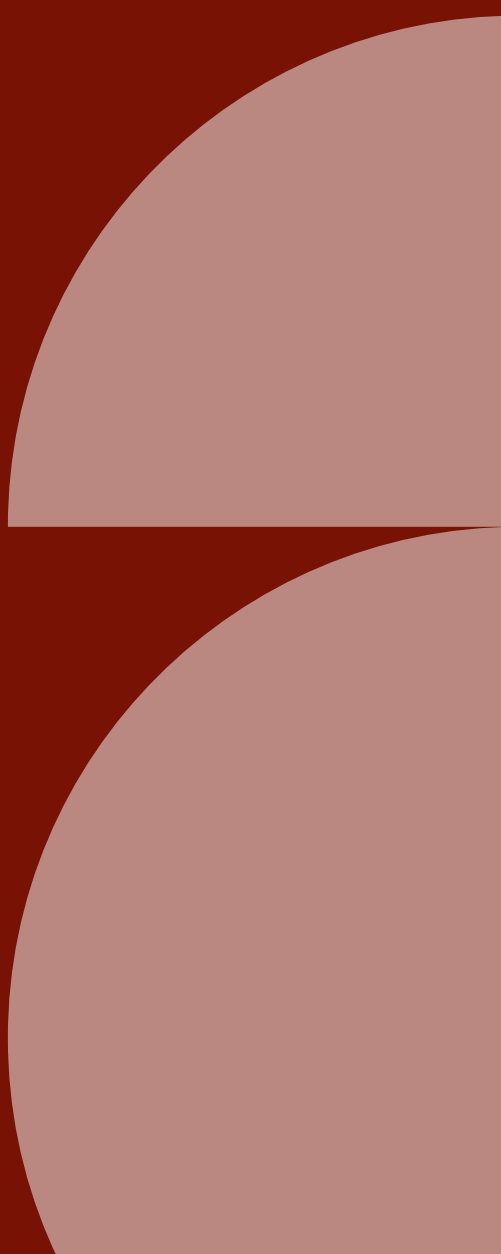
- cultural norms
 - institutional policies
 - everyday interactions
- 

Where was this seen our readings?



QUOTES ANALYSIS

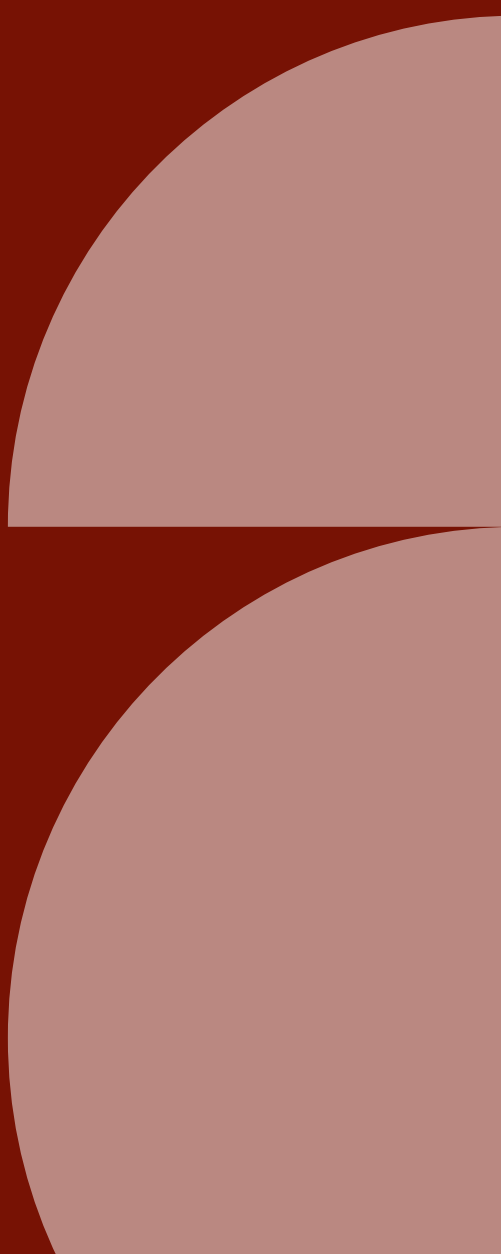
Let's analyze these quotes:

- **Jill Suttie**
 - **Psychologist, writer for *Greater Good* magazine**
 - “On the one hand, having power can decrease our ability to take another’s perspective and lessen our compassionate care. This can lead us to objectify others and think of them only as a means to benefit ourselves.
 - On the other hand, having power also makes us feel less distressed in social situations and more resilient if we are rejected. It also can make us more attuned to others—if we have a kind and helpful orientation in the first place—and make us feel more authentic, attract friends, and, of course, have influence.”
- 



QUOTES ANALYSIS

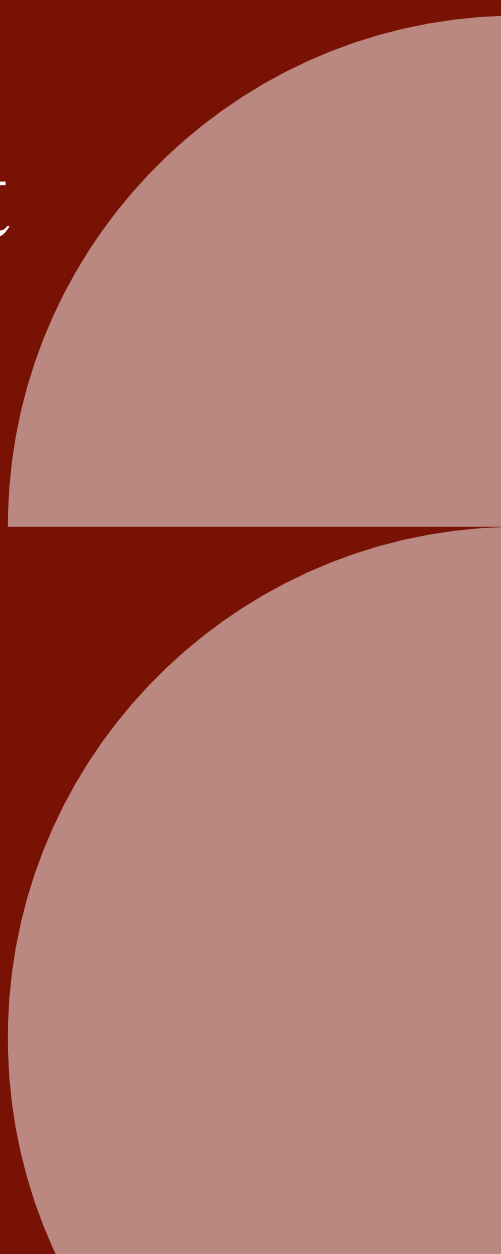
Let's analyze these quotes:

- **Winona LaDuke**
 - **Anishinaabekwe (Ojibwe) enrolled member of the Mississippi Band Anishinaabeg, author, and environmental and Indigenous rights activist**
 - “Power is not brute force and money; power is in your spirit. Power is in your soul. It is what your ancestors, your old people gave you. Power is in the earth; it is in your relationship to the earth.”
- 



QUOTES ANALYSIS

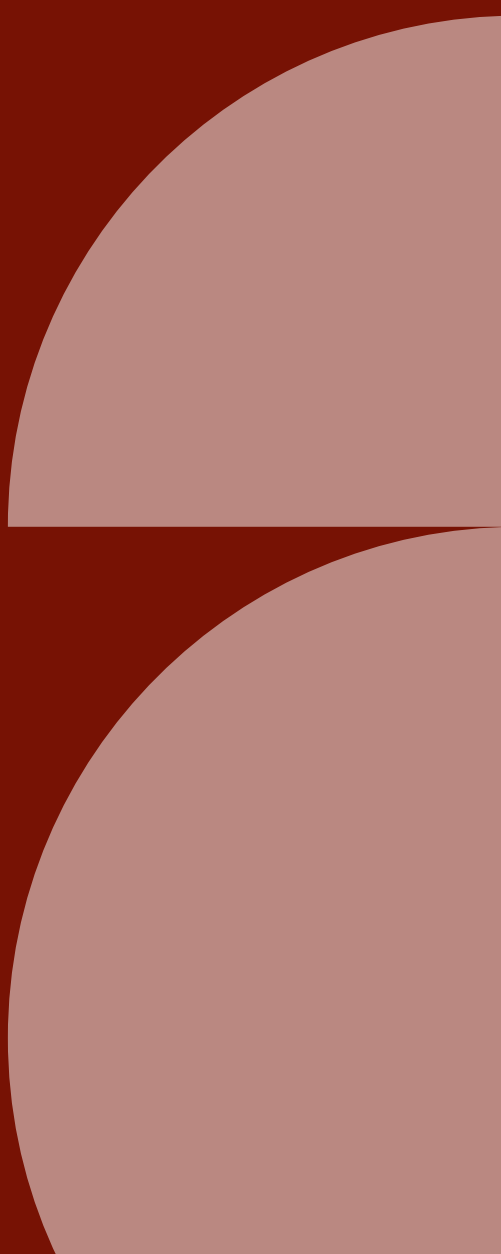
Let's analyze these quotes:

- **Dolores Huerta**
 - **Co-founder of the United Farm Workers union, labor activist, and leader of the Chicano movement**
 - “We just have to convince other people that they have power. This is what they can do by participating to make change, not only in their community, but many times changing in their own lives. Once they participate, they get their sense of power.”
- 



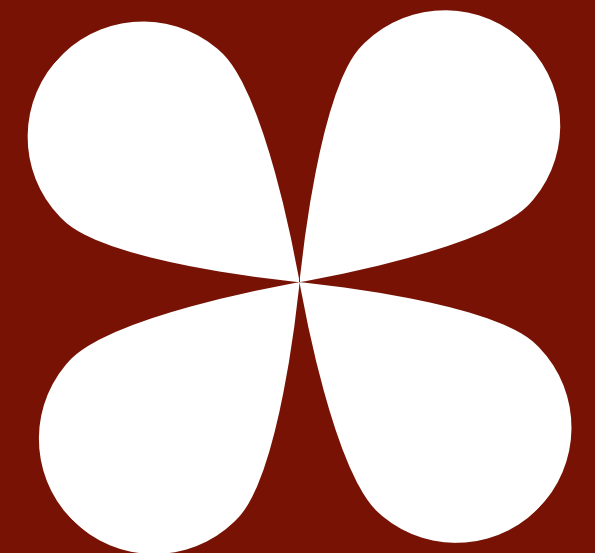
QUOTES ANALYSIS

Let's analyze these quotes:

- **Toni Morrison**
 - **Award-winning author, playwright, and essayist**
 - “I tell my students, ‘When you get these jobs that you have been so brilliantly trained for, just remember that your real job is that if you are free, you need to free somebody else. If you have some power, then your job is to empower somebody else. This is not just a grab-bag candy game.’”
- 

✿ UPCOMING ASSIGNMENTS

- a. Write a 100 to 250-word reflection on what you are most interested in learning in this course (based on the syllabus and our first class) and suggest a topic that you would have incorporated into our syllabus. Due 2/1/26
- b. Check Canvas for the readings for the next class and reflection questions



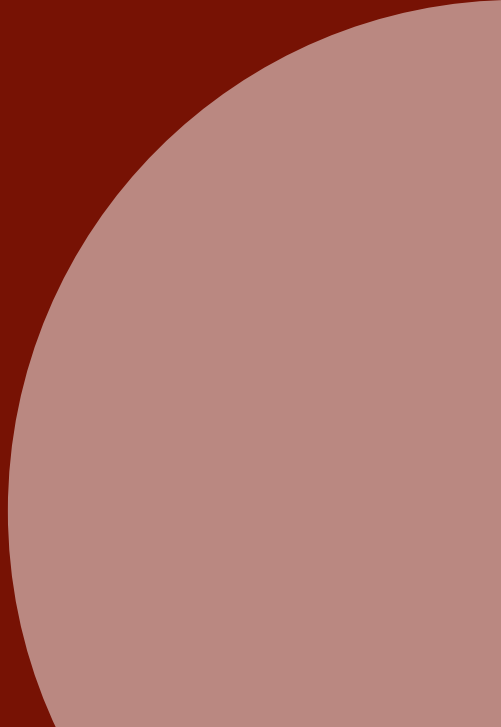
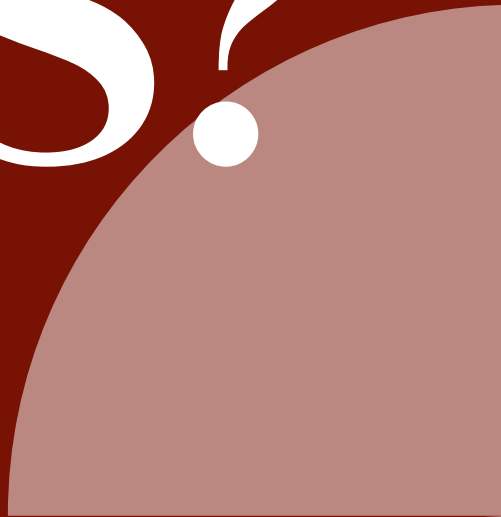


ANY QUESTIONS?

Contact us via email:

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THANK
YOU

